

Arrow function with parameters in parenthesis and function body is an expression.

One major advantage of using arrow functions is the binding of *this*. It is well known that in JavaScript, there is the annoyance of the *this* keyword taking different values based on invocation. In contrast, in arrow functions, *this* has lexical scoping, which means there is no binding. The value of *this* is determined by the containing function. This solves many side effects in callback handlers. Developers who have used libraries like jQuery should be more familiar with this issue.

With these advantages, it might seem that arrow functions are clear replacements to regular functions. While this makes sense in most cases, some differences remain.

Comparison with traditional functions

In comparison with traditional functions, arrow functions cannot be used as constructors. The value of *this* is fixed and cannot be changed. The local object *arguments* is not associated with the arrow function, but the calling function.

List processing

```
[1,2,3,4].map(function (x) {
  return console.log(x * x);
});
```

In ES6

```
[1,2,3,4].map(x => console.log(x*x));
```

Features support

The features covered this month are supported by the latest version of Chrome, Firefox and Node 4.0 environments. For more granular feature support, refer to Kangax matrix in *References*.

In the next part in this series, we will cover the set of features related to function parameters. These are: default function parameters, rest parameters and the spread operator. 

References

- [1] Play around with ES6 features online <http://www.es6fiddle.net/>
- [2] Tail call optimisation through arrow functions <https://leanpub.com/understandings6/read#leanpub-auto-arrow-functions>
- [3] Kangax support matrix <http://kangax.github.io/compat-table/es6/>

By: Janardan Revuru

The author works at Hewlett Packard Enterprise R&D centre in Bengaluru. He is passionate about JavaScript and related Web frameworks. He can be reached for career consulting at janardan.revuru@gmail.com

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